

AFLEWO Technology Readiness Report

For the AFLEWO Core Leadership Team

The Current State: A Smart, Lean Foundation

AFLEWO's website and check-in system run on a lean setup costing about \$39 a month. For everything the platform has needed so far, this has been the right call. Nothing about the current spend is wasteful or careless.

But the platform is about to face its first real test.

The Challenge Ahead

On October 2nd 2026, this year's AFLEWO event is expected to draw 10,000 or more people, many of whom will engage with the site at any corresponding format we use (e.g. QR code, link etc.) within the same few minutes. That kind of concentrated demand is very different from the platform's normal day-to-day traffic, and it exposes a set of gaps that don't matter until that exact moment, and then - suddenly - they matter enormously.

We need to prepare for the 'suddenly'. By God's Grace, we'll definitely be ready!

Here is the honest picture. The core system is solid. You've seen the site already by now. We've already commenced deep work into what's needed for the site. What's missing is the equivalent of a fire alarm and a practiced fire drill: the tools that tell someone the moment something goes wrong, and the rehearsal that proves the system can handle the rush before it actually happens.

What It Does	Plain Description	Status
Hosting	Runs and delivers the website	Working
Database	Stores member data, attendance, chapter records	Working, needs a temporary boost on event day
Security layer	Blocks attacks and overload	Paid for, under configuration for full setup
Load testing	A rehearsal proving the system survives a rush	Not yet done

What It Does	Plain Description	Status
Incident plan	A written playbook for what to do if something fails live	Not yet done
Monitoring	Alerts key AFLEWO personnel the instant something breaks	Present, under configuration for full setup

What This Actually Costs

The financial cost of closing these gaps is small. The real cost, and the part most often overlooked, is the specialized engineering time required to do it properly.

Getting safely through the next event

- Monthly cost: \$59
- Setup time: 8 to 10 hours of specialized engineering work
- Market value of that labor: \$400 to \$500, at a conservative \$50 an hour

Getting ready for repeated, larger events over the next year

- Monthly cost: \$84 normally, rising to about \$234 in the month of a major event
- Setup time: 9 to 17 additional hours
- Market value of that labor: \$450 to \$850

Supporting a multi-country website setup (a future consideration, not a current need)

- Monthly cost: \$1,000 to \$1,500 or more
- One-time mobile app build: \$5,000 to \$10,000 or more (though this can be realised now too)
- Ongoing technical staff: \$300 to \$800 a month
- This tier is not needed today. It only becomes relevant once AFLEWO has independent chapters across several countries and well over 50,000 members.

Why This Matters More Than the Dollar Figure Suggests

If AFLEWO hired an outside agency to design, build, and stress-test a system like this, the market rate looks like this:

Option	Typical Cost
Full agency build from scratch	\$15,000 to \$40,000
Freelance senior cloud engineer, same scope	\$4,000 to \$20,000

Option	Typical Cost
Ongoing managed hosting and monitoring	\$300 to \$800 a month
What AFLEWO is actually paying	\$39 to \$84 a month, plus roughly \$850 to \$1,350 in donated labor

AFLEWO's leadership already understands the scale of specialized work behind this platform, and is fully open to seeing that value quantified rather than left unspoken.

Of the \$10,000 to \$30,000 this work would typically command on the open market, here's our considerations on cost-valuation for the entire project: a) we shall consider a large portion of the amount as our own personal donation back to AFLEWO (in cost, kind and labour) b) a second valuable consideration to offset the net amount lower: since AFLEWO already deals with a highly concentrated audience of singers and musicians, and we have a platform endeared to this very audience, setting Saem's Tunes in a partnership with AFLEWO to the tune of being AFLEWO's designated learning and practice partner, supplying curriculum and practice material to AFLEWO's members directly through the dashboard. c) The costs cancel out significantly & this can be made seamless through the website (we've created a demo for the same on the site). The final costs are reflected in this report but can be deliberated on for adjustments.

Recording this arrangement clearly matters for the same reasons as before, internal clarity and anything like grant reporting or annual summaries, but the structure itself is worth naming precisely. This is a partnership, not a discount, and the value runs in both directions rather than one.

The Path Forward: Three Months to Event Night

The work ahead is already defined for us. The riskiest gaps close first. The final month is rehearsal only, with no new building.

Month 1: Foundations and a Safety Net The goal is simple. If something breaks, someone finds out immediately instead of from a member's complaint.

- Week 1: Domain properly secured, downtime alerts turned on, crash tracking installed
- Week 2: Security rules written to block attacks, key pages made to load instantly
- Week 3: Database checked and confirmed ready for a traffic spike, billing moved to a payment method that won't fail mid-event
- Week 4: A second trusted person given emergency access, account ownership moved from a personal email to an organizational one

Leadership is needed to: approve the organizational email setup, name a backup contact, confirm the billing method.

Month 2: Building the Event-Specific Features The goal is a working check-in system, proven under a simulated rush.

- Weeks 5 to 6: The QR check-in system built, including a manual backup option
- Week 7: A safe practice version of the site created for testing changes before they go live
- Week 8: A simulated rush of 500 or more people tested against that practice version, with fixes made before it's real

Leadership is needed to: review the check-in flow from a member's point of view, decide whether SMS backup is worth the added cost.

Month 3: Rehearsal and Sign-Off No new building happens this month. Only testing, documenting, and final approval.

- Week 9: A plain-language incident plan written, usable by anyone on the team
- Week 10: A full dress rehearsal at real event scale
- Week 11: A final check that the Terms of Service and data handling meet basic privacy expectations
- Week 12: A go or no-go review with leadership before doors open

Leadership is needed to: attend the Week 12 review, approve the plan for communicating with members if something goes wrong.

The Governance Ask

Several of the biggest risks here cannot be solved by engineering alone. They require a decision from leadership.

- **Approve the budget.** Roughly \$60 to \$90 a month for the website (minus labour costs) is a small price for the protection it buys.
- **Name a backup person** with emergency access to the systems. This does not need to be a technical role. It only needs to be someone reachable who can relay instructions if the one person who understands the technology is unavailable.
- **Confirm ownership** of AFLEWO's technology accounts and data. If everything currently sits under one individual's personal email and card, that is a governance gap worth closing.
- **Sign off on how member data is handled.** What is collected, how long it is kept, and what happens if someone asks for it to be deleted.
- **Record the donated engineering time** in AFLEWO's own books. It is worth thousands of dollars and should not be treated as invisible.
- **Show up for the Week 12 review.** It will take under an hour and gives leadership the final word before the event begins.

The Bottom Line

AFLEWO is not starting from zero, and it is not overspending. The \$39 a month setup was the right choice for where the platform has been. What has changed is the stakes. A live event with thousands of people does not get a second chance if something fails.

The full body of work needed to close every gap in this report, monitoring, security rules, the QR check-in system, SMS backup, load testing, and the incident plan, adds up to roughly 17 to 27 hours of focused engineering time. That is not a three month job. It is closer to two to three focused weeks of building, based on the same pace already proven on Nasaka IEBC, where a national geocoding platform handling over 24,000 centres was built, scaled, and hardened under real public pressure, and on CEKA, where a full Crisis and Continuity Manual, security audit, and infrastructure hardening were delivered ahead of a known high-stakes date, the Finance Bill anniversary, without missing that deadline.

That track record is the basis for this conclusion: the three month runway in this report is not the minimum time required. It is a deliberately safe margin. The realistic path is two to three weeks to build everything, followed by a long, unhurried stretch of testing, rehearsal, and leadership review, with the entire final month held in reserve purely for dress rehearsals and final sign-off rather than last minute construction.

This is a confident conclusion, not a hopeful one. The team has already shipped comparable infrastructure, under comparable pressure, on comparable deadlines, more than once.

AFLEWO Night will be built the same way, early, tested well ahead of time, and ready long before the doors open. The only outstanding items are not necessarily technical. They are the six governance decisions above, and they can be closed out in a single leadership meeting.